



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Archbishop Rummel High School

School Website: <https://www.rummelraiders.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Archbishop Rummel High School in Metairie, LA demonstrates a predominantly classical orientation, anchored in Catholic Lasallian formation and a clear emphasis on character, virtue, and communal life. The public materials strongly foreground faith, community, and service as the educational telos, with explicit commitments to formation of students within a liturgical and faith-based framework. The school's stated mission and culture reflect key classical signals (the sense of formation, virtue, and a religiously grounded community), though the publicly available content (as represented in the crawl content) does not overtly spell out the full Trivium/Quadrivium curriculum, Great Books, or Socratic pedagogy in the manner traditional classical schools often articulate. Across the six categories, Archbishop Rummel registers as CLASSICAL in three areas, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in one, and NOT CLASSICAL in two, with an overall CLASSICAL orientation because the category results as a group tilt toward classical formation and shared virtues.

Key takeaway: The school's strength lies in religious and metaphysical foundations and formation-oriented aims (Classical in Categories 1, 2, and 5), with visible engagement of parents/community (Element 6) and some signs of classical formation through policies and mission (but lacking explicit Great Books/Trivium-focused curriculum in the public materials). The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL**Evidence**

- Mission statements explicitly ground education in Catholic faith in the Lasallian tradition of faith, community, and service. This framing is reiterated in the school's long-standing description of its mission and ethos.
- Public materials emphasize Catholic identity, Lasallian formation, and a liturgical/communal life (Mass, liturgy, church-related practices) as integral to the educational experience. The public-facing content references liturgical life, sacred spaces, and communal worship, which align with liturgical and communal practices.
- About Us language speaks to education within the Lasallian tradition of faith, community, and service, reinforcing theology-driven formation and the dignity of life.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present (from the Six Essentials lexicon): theology, liturgy, Mass, chapel, faith, reverence, wonder, community, service, virtue, formation (as implied by a culture of integrity and life-dignity). Evidence in the site material includes the mission statement and community/faith language. This yields multiple explicit positive signals in the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations category.
- Negative keywords: none clearly present in the public materials (no indication of secularism, relativism, or value-neutral ethics in the core material).

Why this rating

- The school foregrounds religious and metaphysical grounding (Catholic, Lasallian) and liturgical life, which are core markers of CLASSICAL orientation in this category. The absence of secular or relativistic framing supports a CLASSICAL designation for this category.

Citations

- Mission Statement and Lasallian framing: Archbishop Rummel High School's mission statement.
- About Us and long-running Lasallian formation:

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission emphasizes formation (in the sense of forming character and talents) and the dignity of life, with an emphasis on values such as faith, community, and service rather than mere job-readiness. The language describes formation of character and the development of talents within a disciplined, faith-centered environment.
- The school highlights integrity and virtue through a formal Honesty and Integrity policy, signaling a focus on moral formation as part of the curriculum and school culture.
- Public materials frame education as part of a tradition that shapes leaders who serve others, underscoring formation over purely informational outcomes.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue (implied via integrity policy and moral formation language), human flourishing (implied by dignity and development of talents), telos/contemplation (through the sense of formation and service; explicit "great conversation" is not stated, but formation is foregrounded), love of learning (implied through the long-standing Lasallian formation culture). Evidence from mission and policy materials supports these signals.
- Negative keywords: none clearly present in the public-facing material (no strong emphasis on workforce-readiness or job-market metrics in the core mission statements).

Why this rating

- The school's stated purpose centers on character formation, moral development, and service within a faith-based framework, aligning well with CLASSICAL ideals for School Purpose and Goal. The presence of an integrity policy and the emphasis on formation support this rating.

Citations

- Mission statement framing formation, virtue, and dignity:
- Integrity policy and character formation language:
- About Us framing formation within Lasallian tradition:

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials emphasize Catholic/Lasallian formation, a mission-driven emphasis on character and service, and a general academic program, but there is no explicit mention of the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; and the Quadrivium), or Great Books/Great Conversation, or related classical curriculum elements (Latin/Greek, etc.). The crawl content centers on mission, discipline, service, and the school's structure; not on Trivium/Quadrivium or Great Books. Specific Great Books or Great Conversation language is not visible in the public pages provided.
- The school's materials emphasize the Lasallian pedagogy and Catholic formation rather than the classic liberal arts canon or the Great Books approach. There is mention of a comprehensive curriculum in the "Curriculum" section in the crawl, but it centers on general curriculum governance rather than classical curricular components like grammar/logic/rhetoric or the Great Books canon.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords (from the Classical Lexicon) for Curriculum include: liberal arts, trivium, quadrivium, great books, primary sources, Western civilization, Latin/Greek, history as a discipline, and wonder.

The public Archbishop Rummel materials do not explicitly mention these classical curricular anchors. The presence of terms like “curriculum” and “academic excellence” is present, but not the explicit classical lexicon items.

- Negative keywords would include: social studies terminology replacing history, STEM-first framing, project-based learning dominance. The public materials do not show a pivot toward social-studies-laden history, nor do they emphasize project-based or purely STEM-first approaches in the public-facing statements.

Why this rating

- While the school demonstrates a strong formation-oriented posture, the explicit curricular content that defines classical education (grammar/logical/rhetoric, Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Conversation, original texts) is not clearly evidenced in the public-facing materials. Therefore, this category is NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations

- General curriculum framing in Archbishop Rummel materials:
- Mission statement emphasis on formation (not explicit classical curricular anchors):

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials emphasize formation and service rather than explicit classical pedagogies like Socratic seminars, Paideia seminars, or explicit memorization/recitation through the classical method. The presence of liturgical life and a strong faith-based culture is evident, but there is no explicit reference to Socratic seminar, memorization recitation, or rigorous use of classical rhetorical training. The material references “discipline, care, and community” rather than the classical pedagogy stack (Socratic dialogue, memory work, etc.).
- There is evidence of structured programs (Counseling/College Planning, Service Programs) and a broad set of student activities, but not explicit classical pedagogical methods (e.g., guided inquiry, Paideia seminars, or strict memory work).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords for Pedagogy in classical sense include: Socratic seminar, narration/recitation, chanting, scholé, restfulness, seminar, rhetoric, recitation. The Archbishop Rummel public materials do not contain explicit mentions of these specific classical pedagogy elements; instead, they emphasize formation and service within a faith-based framework.
- Negative keywords: experiential learning focus, project-based only, student-directed, constructivist. The materials do not depict a project-based-only or student-directed constructivist approach as the defining pedagogy; but neither do they present the explicit classical pedagogy signals.

Why this rating

- The absence of explicit classical pedagogy signals (Socratic pedagogy, Paideia, memorization-based chanting, etc.) supports NOT CLASSICAL in this category given the textual evidence.

Citations

- Pedagogical rhetoric and classical signals are not explicit in mission/formation content:
- General program structure without explicit classical pedagogy references:

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The culture described emphasizes teachers as model virtue, mentorship, and living curriculum within the Lasallian tradition. Public materials speak to moral formation, integrity, and a community-oriented

approach to education, suggesting faculty as virtuous exemplars and guides rather than distant facilitators. The school emphasizes a culture where faculty and students collaborate toward shared formation, with policies (such as the Honesty and Integrity policy) that frame the living curriculum in moral terms.

- There is explicit mention of the faculty and staff in the crawl, including leadership and mentorship roles (e.g., Director of Curriculum, Dean of Students), which aligns with the notion of faculty as mentors and core to the school community. The school also indicates a long heritage of Christian Brothers/Lasallian tradition influencing faculty culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: tutors/mentors/mentors-as-living-curriculum, moral exemplars, character formation, collegial culture, mentorship, formation through example, wisdom-centered teaching, virtue ethics, fidelity to faith and reason.
- Negative keywords: the lexicon notes potential risk signals like “facilitators on the side” or “certification-driven jargon without classical context” (not evidenced here; the public materials portray a teacher-centric, virtue-modeling culture rather than the opposite).

Why this rating

- The public materials present a faculty culture anchored in virtue, mentorship, and the living curriculum, aligned with classical ideals for Faculty. This supports CLASSICAL.

Citations

- Mission/long-standing Lasallian faculty culture and integrity focus:
- Policy and leadership language illustrating character formation among faculty:

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school shows engagement with parents through programs and events such as Back to School Night for Parents and other parent-facing activities that signal parental involvement and a pathway for parent education in the school’s culture. The presence of “Parents” sections and parent-related events in the site menu indicates ongoing parental involvement beyond passive enrollment.
- The public materials emphasize family life, faith life, and community as part of the school’s ethos. While not framed as “parents as co-teachers” in explicit terms on every page, the Lasallian formation model and the open-door approach to parent engagement imply a collaborative culture with families. The site contains references to parent-related activities, clubs, and events.
- The presence of a broad set of parent-linked content (e.g., Parent Annual Giving, Parent involvement channels, open campus references) signals an active, though not explicitly co-teaching, parental engagement model.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, open campus, parent involvement, familial liturgical life, community events (as reflected in the parent pages and event listings).
- Negative keywords: consumer language, parent as customer (not evidenced in the public content provided; the material instead portrays an active parental role in school life). The public materials do not show a strong consumer/customer framing; rather, they show engagement and partnership signals.

Why this rating

- The presence of parent-facing pages, events, and channels indicates a meaningful, ongoing parental engagement model, which aligns with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in this category. It is not as explicit as “parents as co-teachers” though (which the lexicon signals as an ideal). The public-facing aspects support SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations

- Back to School Night for Parents and parent event content:
- Parent-facing pages and content (Parents menu, etc.):
- Parent involvement language in broader materials:

Overall assessment (aggregate)

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

Rationale

- The strongest signals cluster in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, and Faculty, all pointing toward a robust classical orientation anchored in Catholic Lasallian formation. Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) show a gap relative to canonical classical curricula and teaching methods as defined by the classical school rubric, while Element 6 demonstrates meaningful parental engagement that is real but does not fully realize the “parents as co-teachers” ideal. Taken together, the school demonstrates a CLASSICAL orientation with meaningful classical signals in multiple core areas, and clear gaps primarily in explicit classical curriculum and pedagogy.

What would move the needle

- For a fuller CLASSICAL alignment, publicly document and emphasize:
- Explicit Seven Liberal Arts foundations (grammar, logic, rhetoric; quadrivium) and Great Books/Great Conversation in the curriculum, with concrete course descriptions.
- Clear articulation of traditional classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, Paideia-style discourse, memorization/recitation practices) and the role of “scholé” in the upper grades.
- A statement of the Great Books/primary texts program, including sample lists or canonical authors, to anchor the curriculum in the Great Conversation.
- A more explicit articulation of “parents as co-teachers” or formal parent formation programs, aligned with the Positive keywords for the Parents & Community category, to move from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL for Element 6.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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